

The Ultimate Modesto ADU Permit Cheat Sheet

Modesto, California — 2026

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■ Modesto ADU — Key Regulations & Local Contacts

Basic Zoning Rules

Regulation	Requirement
Maximum Size	1,200 sq ft
Property Setbacks	4 ft rear, 4 ft side
Extra Parking	Not required
Owner Occupancy	Not required

■ Local Planning Department

Department: Planning & Building Department

Phone: (209) 577-5200

Email: planning@modestogov.com

Address: 1010 10th St, Modesto, CA 95354

Hours: Check website

■ Key Links

- **Permit Application:** <https://www.modestogov.com/272/Building-Permits>
- **Zoning Map:** <https://www.modestogov.com/145/Zoning>
- **City Website:** <https://www.modestogov.com>

■ Estimated Fees

- Permit fee: \$500-1,500
- Impact fees: \$2,000-5,000
- Plan check: \$200-800

■ Modesto ADU — Project Checklist

- Verify zoning compliance — confirm your property is zoned for ADU
- Check lot size, setbacks, and height restrictions on the zoning map
- Prepare preliminary site plan and floor plan (can be hand-drawn)
- Complete the building permit application form
- Gather required documents: site plan, floor plan, elevations, title report
- Submit application package to the Planning Department
- Pay plan check and permit fees
- Wait for plan review (typically 4-8 weeks)
- Address any correction notices from the reviewer
- Receive approved permit
- Schedule inspections during construction (foundation, framing, electrical, final)
- Obtain certificate of occupancy upon completion

■ *Tip: Contact the local planning department early in your process — they can save you months of back-and-forth by identifying issues upfront.*